

# 08 Common English idioms

## 8.1 COMMON ENGLISH IDIOMS

Tamsin **got cold feet** about giving a presentation to the sales team.

**to get cold feet**

[to have a sudden loss of confidence]



Susan is **feeling under the weather** today. I think she should go home.

**to feel under the weather**

[to feel unwell, sick, or ill]



Ben and Rachel are **head over heels** in love with each other.

**head over heels**

[completely and utterly in love with someone]



You're so right about Jim. He's really lazy! You've **hit the nail on the head**.

**to hit the nail on the head**

[to describe exactly what is causing a situation or problem]



Can I **lend a hand** carrying those papers for you?

**to lend a hand**

[to help someone with something]



I'm so tired today! I'm really not **on the ball**.

**on the ball**

[alert, knowledgeable, or competent]



I **heard on the grapevine** that Neil and Amina are getting married.

**to hear something on the grapevine**

[to hear information or news through gossip or rumor]



Hamid is working **against the clock** to finish his report this week.

**against the clock**

[under time pressure to get something done]



Dylan is being so naughty today! He's **a pain in the neck**.

**a pain in the neck**

[a nuisance, annoying, or difficult]



I'm looking for someone to **keep an eye on** my house while I'm on vacation.

**to keep an eye on**

[to take care of or watch carefully]

